Ellie Thompson.



BRAND MANAGER · MARKETING DIRECTOR · CREATIVE STRATEGIST

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Brand leader with seven years growing consumer food brands from the inside out, and the person behind the transformation of a 25-year-old brand into *Maeve Chocolate*. Psychology grad who pairs consumer insight with a sharp design eye: the idea person who sells the vision internally, directs world-class creative partners, and turns concepts into award-winning, record-breaking products.

110%	+12%	4	36 hrs	5.5×
YOY ECOMMERCE GROWTH POST-REBRAND	YOY WHOLESALE GROWTH, LARGEST CHANNEL	NATIONAL DESIGN AWARDS: 3 DIELINE, 1 WEBBY	FASTEST PRODUCT SELLOUT IN COMPANY HISTORY	EMAIL LIST GROWTH, 10K to 55k

Experience

Seattle Chocolate Company · Maeve Chocolate & jcoco

Seattle, WA | May 2019 – Jun 2026

Promoted four times in six years, from Sales Operations to Director of Marketing, at a 75-person national confections company.

Director of Marketing

AUG 2025 – JUN 2026

- Led all marketing as the department's voice on the executive leadership team, managing a 6-person in-house team plus 10 agency partners across two creative agencies.
- Conceived, pitched, and licensed an official collaboration with the bestselling novel *Dungeon Crawler Carl*. The resulting bar became the fastest sellout in company history and landed in the top 5 highest-volume products of all time within weeks of launch.
- Brought the brand to **PAX West**, an entirely new audience, where booth demand ran so high the venue stationed permanent security to manage the line.
- Secured placement in **Pop Up Grocer** after years of persistent outreach, expanding the brand's reach with trend-forward retail audiences.

Brand Manager → Senior Brand Manager

APR 2021 – AUG 2025

SIGNATURE PROJECT

The Maeve Rebrand

Conceived and led the complete reinvention of the company's 25-year-old namesake brand, Seattle Chocolate, into **Maeve Chocolate** , the largest initiative in company history. Owned strategy and final decisions across 75+ reimagined products, packaging, the website, merchandising, trade show booths, sales decks, competitive analysis, launch PR, and post-launch campaigns, and served as the rebrand's public face on TV, podcasts, and in press interviews. The launch carried the brand into national retail for the first time (including Sprouts, with natural grocery ACV up 3 points) and drove every result in the scoreboard above.

SEE THE WORK → maevechocolate.com

- Hired and directed creative agency **The Young Jerks** after auditioning (and parting with) several others; authored the substance of the brand guidelines and drove detailed creative feedback on every concept for four years.
- Partnered with web agency **ViewSource** on the Maeve website, which won a Webby Award for its design.
- Owned five seasonal campaigns per year end to end, spanning 30+ limited-time products plus email, paid social and search, organic social, PR, influencer, and brand collaborations.
- Creative-directed 15 photoshoots, growing from on-set assistant to owning concepts, shot lists, prop sourcing, contractor and photographer hiring, and on-set direction.
- Reimagined the factory tour and flagship store twice, from concept and script to videos, run of show, merchandising, and key builds, all designed to transport guests into Maeve's magical world.

Experience, continued

Brand Manager → Senior Brand Manager, continued
APR 2021 – OCT 2025

- Partnered with the sales team daily, creating hundreds of pieces of collateral over the years: sales decks, catalogs, in-store signage, displays, caddies, shippers, shelf tags, and broker mailings.
- Represented the brands at major trade shows including the Fancy Food Shows, Natural Products Expo West, Sweets & Snacks Expo, the NW Chocolate Festival, and Fine Chocolate Industry Association events.
- Grew Instagram from 16K to 40K followers and built the email program behind the subscriber growth shown on page one.
- Co-managed sister brand **jcoco** (craft, culinary-inspired): shaped its 2020 brand refresh, concepted new flavors, and helped create its brand and style guide.

Marketing Coordinator
DEC 2019 – APR 2021

- Executed digital campaigns, retail collateral, and photoshoot production across both brands; earned promotion to Brand Manager within 16 months.

Sales Operations Specialist
MAY 2019 – DEC 2019

- Joined directly out of college supporting wholesale operations; promoted into marketing within seven months.

Beyond the Desk

- **Origin sourcing & storytelling:** traveled to cocoa farms in Ghana, Costa Rica, Nicaragua, Ecuador, Peru, and Brazil to meet farmers, shape farmer-support initiatives, and capture content for web, social, and advertising; trained hands-on in bean-to-bar chocolate making.
- **Speaker:** industry panels on the climate crisis and its impact on cocoa; guest speaker at the UW Foster School of Business on the Maeve rebrand.
- **Utility player:** at a 75-person company, served as a go-to brainstorm partner for every department and helped lead company-wide strategic planning sessions.

Recognition & Expertise

★ **Dieline Awards (3)**
2nd place for Maeve's everyday bar line, plus two wins for seasonal collections. All three were projects conceived and led personally.

★ **Webby Award**
Maeve Chocolate website, created with agency ViewSource.

★ **NEXTY Awards Finalist**
Natural Products Expo West, 2025.

Brand strategy & positioning / Creative direction / Product development & LTOs / Licensing & partnerships / Integrated campaigns / Agency & vendor management / Consumer psychology / Retail & experiential / Sales enablement / PR & public speaking

Featured In

MSNBC · KING 5 News · Evening Magazine · FOX 13 Seattle · Seattle Magazine · Seattle Refined · Bizwomen · Candy & Snack TODAY · The Sweet Life (NCA) · Transform Magazine · Natural Products Insider · Alaska Airlines in-flight media

Named one of Seattle Business Magazine's Best Companies to Work For during tenure.

Education

Scripps College · Claremont, CA
BA in Psychology, focus in Media Studies · May 2019